



Hike receives funding

Hike recently received \$175 million and is now valued at \$1.4 billion.
<http://dgit.in/HikeFnd>



Apple -1 for auction

You can't call yourself a loyal Apple fanboy unless you have one of these vintage machines.
<http://dgit.in/Apple1Actn>

Space Age

are far from inert. Photo's showed large hexagonal cell shaped features on Pluto which scientists say is due to a process called Rayleigh Bernard convection. Large rifts and cracks on the surface of Pluto lays credence to the theory that beneath its icy crust is a liquid ocean. Amidst all the brouhaha over structures on Mars, and on Saturn's moon – Titan, Pluto has quietly made a mark. It's not a frozen marble out in the dark. It's rife with activity and movement.

07 There are a thousand wandering black holes in our celestial backyard

Black holes are perhaps the scariest objects to exist in space. They are essentially super massive objects condensed in a tiny speck of matter, so dense that nothing escapes its gravitational pull. Most artists impressions show black holes as these eerie bodies eating up another helpless stellar body close to it. Black holes do indeed do that and they come in various sizes. Now to make matters worse scientists posit that black holes need not be lazy, static hungry beasts but agile rogue ones as well. When two galaxies collide in a event for the ages (literally) it may lead to an ejection of a black hole, which would then wander about in space, at high speeds, devouring everything within its capture radius. According to some studies there may be as many as 2,000 of these rogue black holes roaming around in our very own Milky Way. While black holes and by extension moving black holes are extremely difficult to detect the hunt is on to map the distribution of these bodies. Rest assured though, it is highly unlikely that a rogue black hole will pay us a visit anytime soon. Highly unlikely. Great, the odds are on our side. But when there are objects, a million times the mass of the sun, moving at high speeds, hurtling about in our galaxy, odds aren't so insignificant, are they?

08 The sun makes up 99% of all the mass in the Solar System

All of us grew up hearing odes to the Sun, about how it supports life on Earth and is vital for almost all life processes.

True, no doubt. But the Sun, besides enabling life and being the centre of our solar system also makes up most of it's mass. Wait, not most, almost all of it. The Sun's diameter is 109 times that of Earth which means its volume is approximately 13,00,000 times that of Earth. It weighs as much as 3,30,000 Earths and within its dense core it generates energy via nuclear fusion. And with all its mass combined it makes up for 99.86% of the weight of the entire solar system. That's right. You take away the Sun and the solar system (besides all planets madly going out of orbit), will lose all its mass. This fact surprising at first glance can be broken down by a simple explanation. Jupiter our biggest planet is 1/1000th the mass of the sun, but weighs 2.5 times the rest of the planets combined. And since space is 99.99% empty, the Sun naturally becomes the most massive object in the Solar System by far.

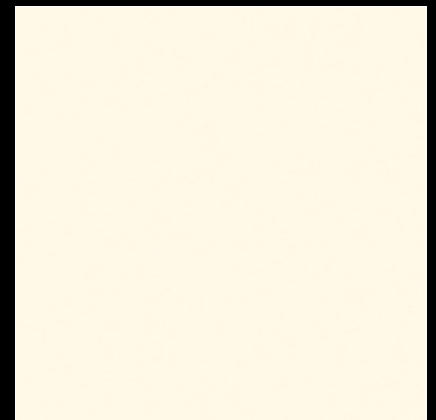
09 The Universe has an average colour and it is beige

In an example of how science could produce fun results, scientists studied light from 2,00,000 galaxies and averaged it out to get an idea what the colour the universe would emit on a smeared out scale. It is surprisingly underwhelming and it is basically a light beige shade. After inviting suggestions the name chosen for the cosmic shade was 'cosmic latte', named after the colour of the latte being sipped by the person who suggested it. No kidding! The name was chosen among other names like Cappuccino Cosmico, Big Bang Buff and Skyvory. The study also indicates that the universe has become less bluer over its evolution and the colour will gradually shift on the colour spectrum to reflect more red. Young stars with more energy reflect more light in the blue spectrum range but over a period of time as their energy diminished, the colour of light they emitted became dominated by red. As the universe ages, this cosmic latte will become darker and we have to replace the name for the average colour as either cosmic mocha or cosmic choco, depending on what you were

eating when you read about this. We joke but you get the sentiment, right?

10 A star sneeze can wipe us out at anytime

We spoke about neutron stars and magnetars earlier in this article. But here we'll highlight another sinister aspect to those damn things. Quakes occurring on them are so powerful that the resulting energy from the nearest one can cause the extinction of mankind on Earth! Magnetars are a sub-class of neutron stars, dense compact objects



The average colour of the universe (CC 3.0)

that rotate with high angular velocity and possess a radically high magnetic field. Sometimes, due to this intense magnetic field, the magnetar changes shape from its rotating equilibrium shape, in the process facing enormous stress in its crust and releasing unprecedented amounts of energy. This event is dubbed a starquake and scientists detected the largest one on record in 2004, on a magnetar 500,000 light years away from Earth. The starquake event would have measured a whopping 22 on the Richter scale. As a part of this quake event, gamma rays were released that had power ~ 10³⁷ Kw. That, to put it mildly, is a planet shattering power burst. In fact scientists feel that had this magnetar starquake occurred closer to the Earth, around 10 light years or less, it would have wiped of every trace of life causing a mass extinction event. Luckily for us there are no magnetars that close to Earth. At least, not until a nearby star undergoes a supernova. Gulp!